

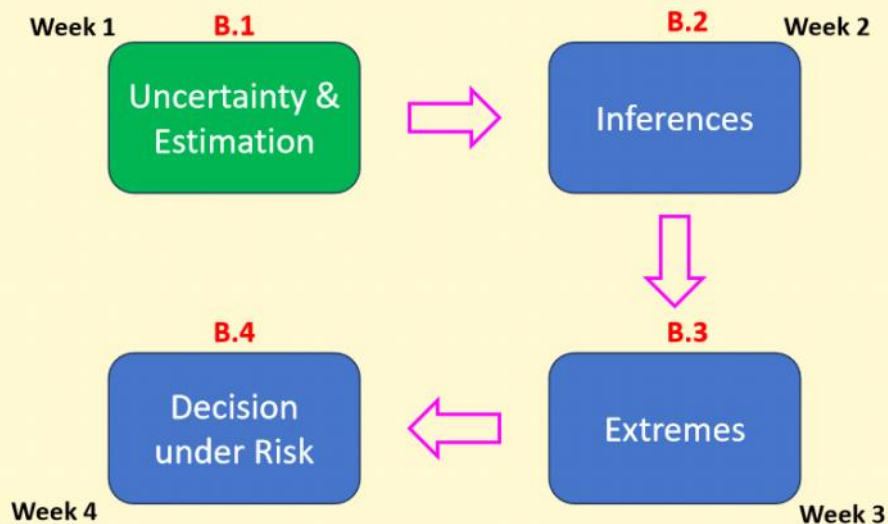
CV 5101

Modeling, Uncertainty, and Data for Engineers

(July – Nov 2026)

Dr. Prakash S Badal

Module Overview



A crash course in probability, probabilistic models, and probabilistic methods.

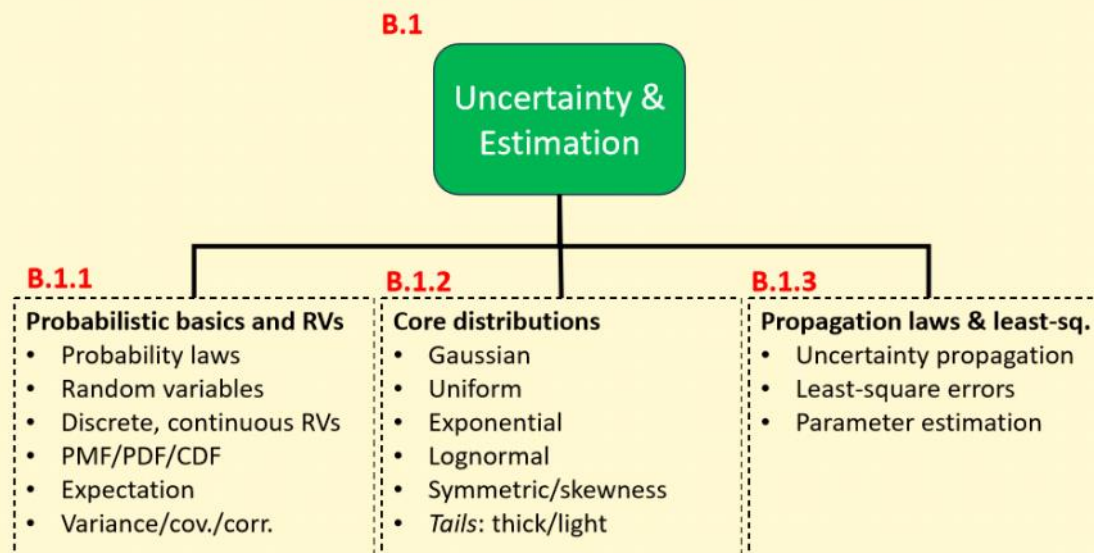
Check-in with teach-book

<https://mude.citg.tudelft.nl/book/2024/>

- Q1 Topics (Chapters 5, 6, 2, and 3)
 - **Q1C5 Univariate continuous distribution**
 - Q1C5.1 PDF/CDF
 - Q1C5.2 Empirical Distributions
 - Q1C5.3 Parametric Distributions
 - Q1C5.4 Fitting a Distribution
 - Q1C6 Multivariate Distributions (briefly)
 - **Q1C2 Propagation of Uncertainty**
 - Q1C3 Observation Theory: least-sq., Hyp. Test, Conf. Intervals
- Q2 Topics (Chapter 7 and 8)
 - **Q2C7 Extreme value theory: GEV, return period, POT**
 - Q2C8 Risk and decision making (CBA)
- Fundamental Concepts
 - **Chapter 6, 7, 8, 9. Probability basics, rv, z- and t-tables**
- Programming
 - Fundamental Concepts → Chapter 10

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Module Overview



B.1.1 Probability basics & random variables

Birthdays!

Birthday-Birthday

Jan 4 14	Feb 22 23	Mar 12 14
Apr 6 15 17	May 6 11 12 14 23	Jun 28 26
Jul	Aug	Sep
Oct	Nov	Dec

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Question 1

Probability that at least two people in this room share the birthday?

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Birthday Problem

$$\Pr(\text{Two people share birthday}) = 1/365$$

$$\Pr(2 \text{ people share birthday in a class of } 40)$$

$$= \frac{364 \times 363 \times \dots \times (365 - n + 1)}{365 \times 365 \times \dots \text{ 40 times}}$$

$$\text{for } n=50, \Pr(\text{at least 2 shared birthdays}) \approx 0.97$$

$$n=23, \Pr(\text{at least 2 shared birthdays}) \approx 0.5$$

Birthday attack $\leftarrow$ collision attack

$$2^{64} \longrightarrow 2^{32}$$

Intuition can be misleading.

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Settlers of Catan



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Practice question

- Work with the **another person around you**.
- You throw 2 dice;
- add the values of each die
- List all the possible outcomes



Q1. What is the probability that **the sum of the two dice will be 6?**

Q2. What is the probability that you get **at least one 8 in a single round**

consisting of four players? $1 - \left(\frac{31}{36}\right)^4$

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Probability axioms

S : Sample space

$$\Pr(S) = 1$$

mutually
exclusive

E : An event

$$0 \leq \Pr(E) \leq 1$$

E_1, E_2 : Two events s.t.

$$E_1 \cap E_2 = \emptyset$$

$$\Pr(E_1 \cup E_2) = \Pr(E_1) + \Pr(E_2)$$

Probability rules

$$Pr(E_1 \cup E_2) = Pr(E_1) + Pr(E_2) - Pr(E_1 \cap E_2)$$

Union ↑

$$Pr(\bar{E}_1) = 1 - Pr(E_1)$$

Complement ↑

$$Pr(E_1 \cup E_2 \cup E_3) = Pr(E_1) + Pr(E_2) + Pr(E_3) - Pr(E_1 \cap E_2) - Pr(E_2 \cap E_3) - Pr(E_3 \cap E_1) + Pr(E_1 \cap E_2 \cap E_3)$$

Inclusion - Exclusion principle

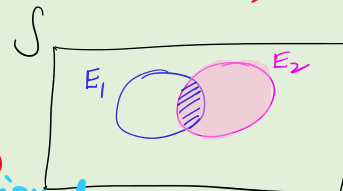
$$Pr\left(\bigcup_{i=1}^n E_i\right) = \sum Pr(E_i) - \sum_{i < j} Pr(E_i \cap E_j) + \sum_{i < j < k} Pr(E_i \cap E_j \cap E_k) - \dots + (-1)^{n-1} Pr(E_1 \cap E_2 \cap \dots \cap E_n)$$

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Probability rules: conditional prob.

- Conditional probability: $Pr(E_1 | E_2) = \frac{Pr(E_1 \cap E_2)}{Pr(E_2)}$

Probability of E_1 given that E_2 has occurred



Marginal

- Multiplication rule:

$$Pr(E_1 \cap E_2) = Pr(E_1 | E_2) \cdot Pr(E_2)$$

$$Pr(E_1 \cap E_2 \cap \dots \cap E_n) = Pr(E_1 | E_2 E_3 \dots E_n) \cdot Pr(E_2 | E_3 E_4 \dots E_n) \cdot \dots \cdot Pr(E_{n-1} | E_n) \cdot Pr(E_n)$$

- Two events are called statistically independent (SI), if

$$Pr(E_1 | E_2) = Pr(E_1)$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{Pr(E_1 \cap E_2)}{Pr(E_2)} = Pr(E_1) \Rightarrow Pr(E_1 \cap E_2) = Pr(E_1) \cdot Pr(E_2)$$

↑ Non-zero unless either $Pr(E_1)$, $Pr(E_2)$ is zero

L2

Sep 2, 2026

Messages from the Last Class

- **Message 1: Space Shuttle Challenger Disaster**

If everything is important, then nothing is!

- **Message 2: Basic Probability**

→ you need to revise prob & stats

→ Sample space, S & Event, E

$$\Pr(S) = 1 \quad 0 \leq \Pr(E) \leq 1$$

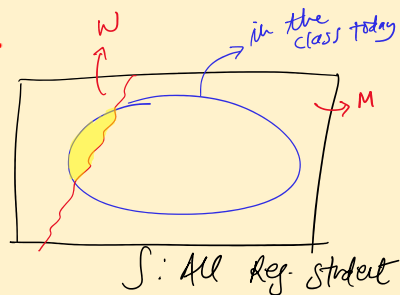
If E_1 & E_2 are exclusive $E_1 \cap E_2 = \emptyset$

$$\Pr(E_1 \cup E_2) = \Pr(E_1) + \Pr(E_2)$$

- **Message 3: Conditional prob.**

$$\rightarrow \Pr(A|B) = \frac{\Pr(A \cap B)}{\Pr(B)}$$

→ Conditioning is equivalent to reducing the sample space.



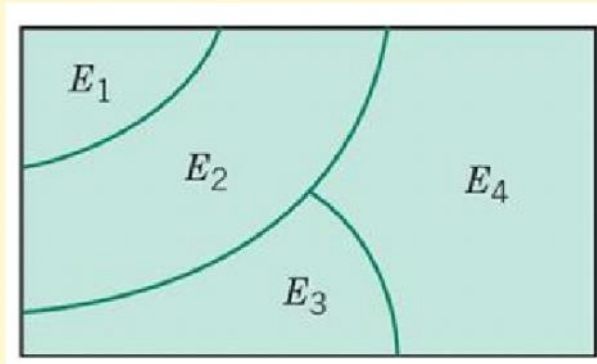
Set Theory: Mutually Exclusive Events

If $E_1, E_2, \dots, E_n$ are such that

$$E_i \cap E_j = \emptyset$$

then

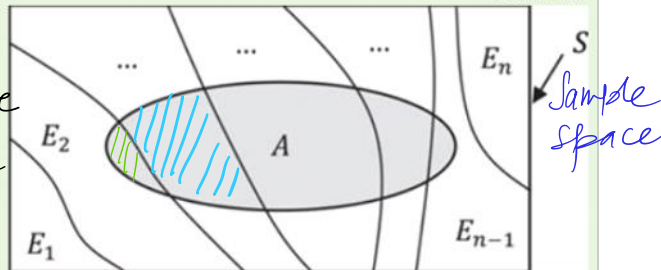
$$Pr(E_1 \cup E_2 \cup \dots \cup E_n) = Pr(E_1) + Pr(E_2) + \dots + Pr(E_n)$$



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Probability rules: total probability rule

- If $E_1, E_2, \dots, E_n$ are n MECE events, Mutually exclusive & collectively exhaustive
 $E_1 \cup E_2 \cup \dots \cup E_n = S$



$$\begin{aligned} Pr(A) &= Pr(AE_1) + Pr(AE_2) + \dots + Pr(AE_n) \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n Pr(AE_i) \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n Pr(A|E_i) \cdot Pr(E_i) \end{aligned}$$

↑ Total Probability Rule

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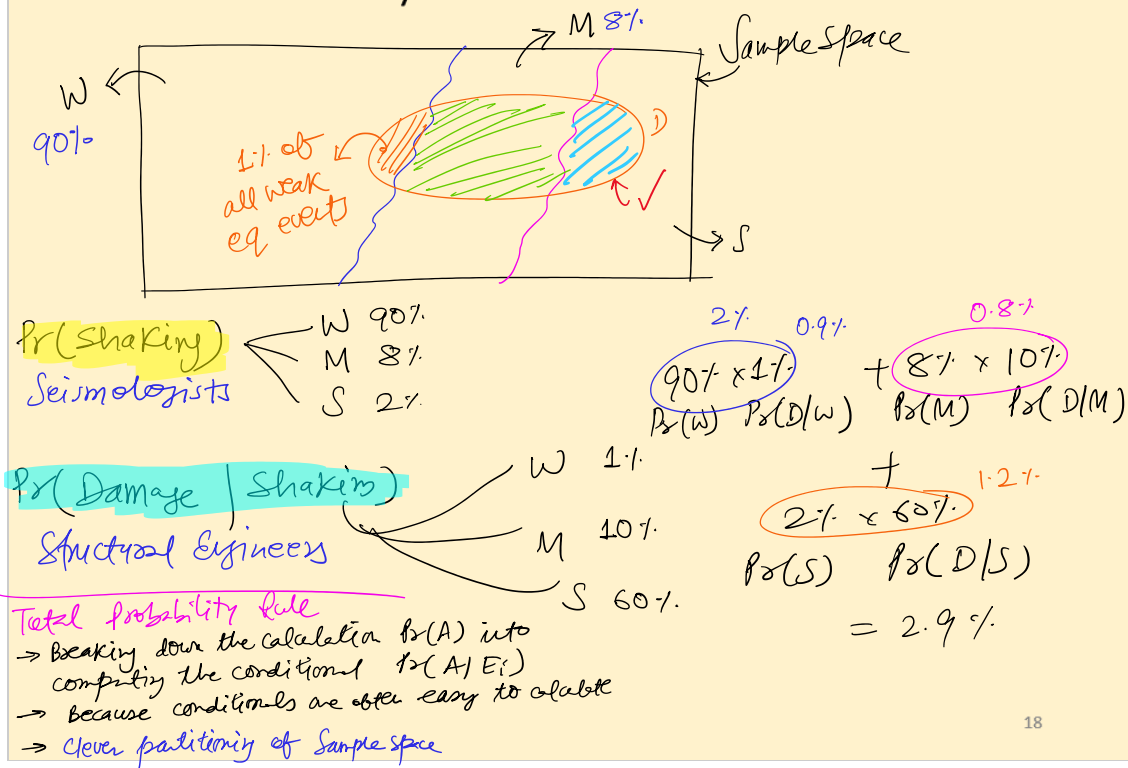
(At home) Probability rules: total probability rule

The probability that a building will sustain damage due to an earthquake depends on the intensity of shaking. Suppose the intensity is discretized into the states of weak, moderate, and strong. Assume it is determined that the probability of damage to the building is 0.01, 0.10, and 0.60 for the three levels of shaking intensity, respectively. Furthermore, based on the history of past earthquakes in the region, it is estimated that, for a randomly occurring earthquake, the probabilities for the three levels of shaking intensity at the site of the building are 0.90, 0.08, and 0.02, respectively. We are interested in the probability that the building will sustain damage during the next earthquake in the region. © ADK22

$$Pr(D|W)$$

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Total Probability Rule: Behind the Scenes!



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Partitioning Complex Structural Systems

probability that Chennai
Airport is closed tomorrow?

Weather prediction

- No rain
- Moderate rain
- Heavy rain
- Cyclone

Prob. that a high-rise building
cannot be evacuated safely
during a fire?

Fire initiation

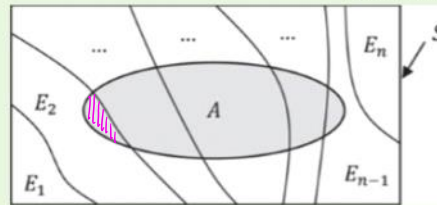
- Basement
- Lower floor
- Middle floor
- Upper floor

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Probability rules: Bayes' rule

- If $E_1, E_2, \dots, E_n$ are n MECE events,

$P_x(E_i|A)$ ← probability of interest



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$$P_x(AE_i) = P_x(E_i|A) \cdot P_x(A) = P_x(A|E_i) \cdot P_x(E_i)$$

$$\rightarrow P_x(E_i|A) = \frac{P_x(A|E_i) \cdot P_x(E_i)}{P_x(A)}$$

$$= \frac{P_x(A|E_i) \cdot P_x(E_i)}{\sum_{j=1}^n P_x(A|E_j) \cdot P_x(E_j)}$$

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(At home) Probability rules: Bayes' rule

- Assume in the previous example that the building has sustained damage. What can we learn about the intensity of the earthquake?

$$\begin{array}{lcl}
 P_r(W|D) = 0.9/2.9 = 31\% & \left| & 90\% \leftarrow P_r(W) \\
 P_r(M|D) = 0.8/2.9 = 27\% & & 8\% \leftarrow P_r(M) \\
 P_r(S|D) = 1.2/2.9 = 41\% & & 2\% \leftarrow P_r(S)
 \end{array}$$

$\uparrow$ posterior $\uparrow$ prior

$$\begin{array}{c}
 P_r(W|D) \\
 P_r(M|D) \\
 P_r(S|D)
 \end{array}
 \quad \vdots \quad
 \begin{array}{c}
 P_r(W) \\
 P_r(M) \\
 P_r(S)
 \end{array}$$

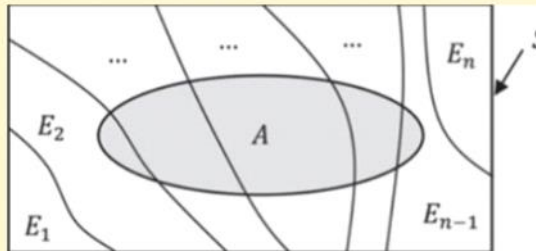
$\nwarrow$

Posterior = likelihood $\times$ prior

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Total Probability Rules & Bayes' rule © ADK22

$E_1, E_2, \dots, E_n$ are (MECE) partitions of S .



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L3

Sep 3, 2026

Total Probability and Bayes' Rule (irl)

Total Probability Rule Q) What will happen?

- $Pr(\text{Cancer}) \rightarrow$ Insurance
- $Pr(\text{flight cancelled}) \rightarrow$ Flight operator
- $Pr(\text{Building collapse}) \rightarrow$ Design standard

Bayes' Rule Q) ^{Now that "this" has happened,} What caused this event?

- Given that a patient has some symptom
 - Request more tests
 - Treatment/Medication depends on these prob.

Murder trial of O. J. Simpson

O. J. Simpson

57 languages

Article Talk

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From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

"The Juice" redirects here. For other uses, see Juice (disambiguation).

Orenthal James Simpson (July 9, 1947 – April 10, 2024), nicknamed "**the Juice**",^[b] was an American football player, actor, and media personality. He played in the National Football League (NFL) for 11 seasons—nine with the Buffalo Bills—and is regarded as one of the greatest running backs of all time. His success is widely considered to be overshadowed by his two criminal charges for the 1994 murders of his ex-wife Nicole Brown and her friend Ron Goldman, and the contentious criminal trial in which he was acquitted on both counts.

Simpson played college football for the USC Trojans, winning the 1968 Heisman Trophy as a senior. He was selected first overall by the Bills in the 1969 NFL/AFL draft. With the Bills, he received five consecutive Pro Bowl and first-team All-Pro selections from 1972 to 1976. He led the league in rushing yards four times, in rushing touchdowns twice, and in points scored in 1975. Simpson became the first NFL player to rush for more than 2,000 yards in a season—earning him 1973's NFL Most Valuable Player (MVP) award—and he is the only player to do so in a 14-game regular season. He also holds the record for the single-season yards-per-game average, at 143.1.

O. J. Simpson



Murder trial of O. J. Simpson

Which probability should the jury care about?

$\Pr(\text{DNA match} \mid \text{innocent})$

Or

$\Pr(\text{guilty} \mid \text{DNA match})$

15-20x
more

Murder trial of O. J. Simpson

DNA expert say, that

$$\Pr(\text{DNA match} | \text{unrelated person}) = \frac{1}{20 \text{ million}}$$

Jury wants to know

$$\Pr(\text{guilty} | \text{DNA match})$$

Bayes' $\Pr(\text{guilty} | \text{DNA match}) = \frac{\Pr(\text{DNA match} | \text{guilty}) \cdot \Pr(\text{guilty})}{\Pr(\text{DNA match})}$

Prosecutor's Bias $\Pr(G | \text{DNA}) \propto \Pr(\text{DNA} | G)$ ← NOT wrong, But incomplete

$$\Pr(G | \text{DNA}) \propto \Pr(\text{DNA} | G) \cdot \Pr(G)$$

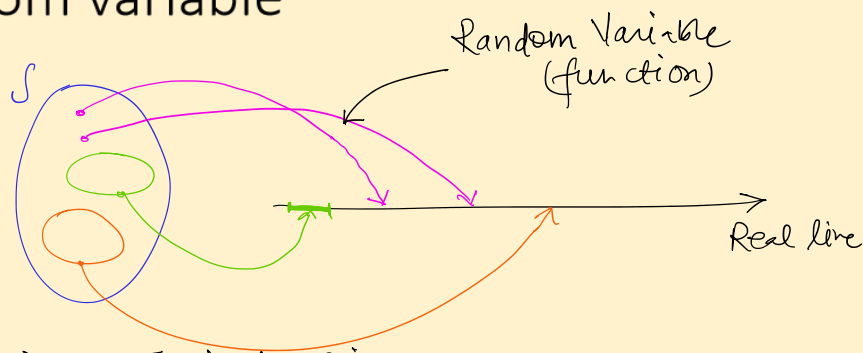
↖ Baseline rate

DNA match $\Rightarrow$ Create guilt

	100,000,000				
	MATCH	NO MATCH			
GUILTY	1	0			
INNOCENT	5	~100,000,000			

Random Variables

Random variable



Experiment: Tossing two coins

Sample space $\{(H,T), (H,H), (T,H), (T,T)\}$

X : Number of heads in two tosses of a coin

$$X(\omega) = \begin{cases} 0 & ; \quad \omega = (T, T) \\ 1 & ; \quad \omega = (H, T) \text{ or } (T, H) \\ 2 & ; \quad \omega = (H, H) \end{cases}$$

↑ Random Variable

RV: misnomer. Neither ^{Random} Variable. It is a function.

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Random variable

- Experiment: rolling two 4-faced dice

X = maximum roll

Domain of X ? $\rightarrow S$

Range of X ? $\rightarrow \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$

$S = ?$

$X(\omega) = ?$

$$X(\omega) = \begin{cases} 1, & \omega = (1, 1) \\ 2, & \omega = (1, 2), (2, 1), (2, 2) \\ 3, & \omega = (1, 3), (2, 3), (3, 1), (3, 2), (3, 3) \\ 4, & \omega = (1, 4), (2, 4), (3, 4), (4, 1), (4, 2), (4, 3), (4, 4) \end{cases}$$

$$Pr(X=1) = 1/16$$

$$Pr(X=2) = 3/16$$

$$Pr(X=3) = 5/16$$

$$Pr(X=4) = 7/16$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^n Pr(X=\omega_i) = 1$$

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Types of RV

Discrete

- Range is finite or countable
- Grade in this course
- # of sand particles on Marissa
- Natural numbers

Continuous

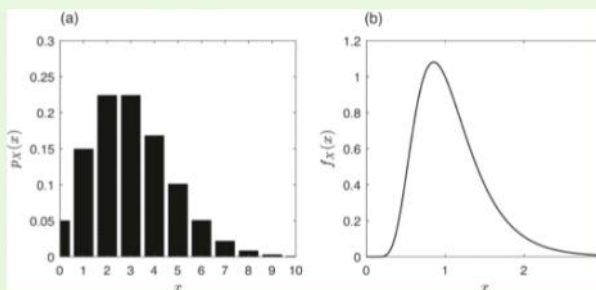
- Range is continuous over some interval
- temperature
- height
- weight
- $x \in (0, 4)$

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Random variable (rv): PMF, PDF

- For a discrete rv:

- For a continuous rv:



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(At home) Random variable (rv): PMF, PDF

- Let X = concrete strength, in the range $[0, 20 \text{ MPa}]$
- Assume a PDF given as:

$$f_X(x) = 0.05 \text{ for } 0 \leq x \leq 20$$

- What is the probability that the strength of a tested concrete is less than 10 MPa?

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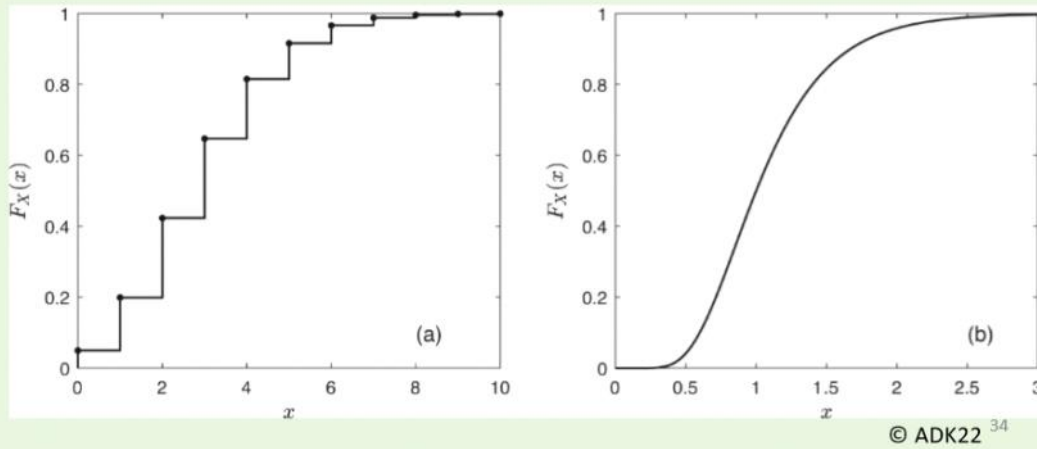
Random variable (rv): CDF

- *Cumulative distribution function* (CDF) is defined as:
- The CDF of a **discrete RV** X is
- The CDF of a **continuous RV** X is

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Random variable (rv): CDF

CDF must satisfy:



Expectation of RV

Expectation

- Let $g(X)$: a function of rv X , with PDF $f_X(x)$.
Expectation of $g(X)$,

$$E[g(X)] =$$

$$E[\sum_i g_i(\mathbf{X})] =$$

- Expectation/mean of X

$$E[X] =$$

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Variance

- Variance is the expected value of $X - \mu_X$,

$$\sigma^2 =$$

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Covariance

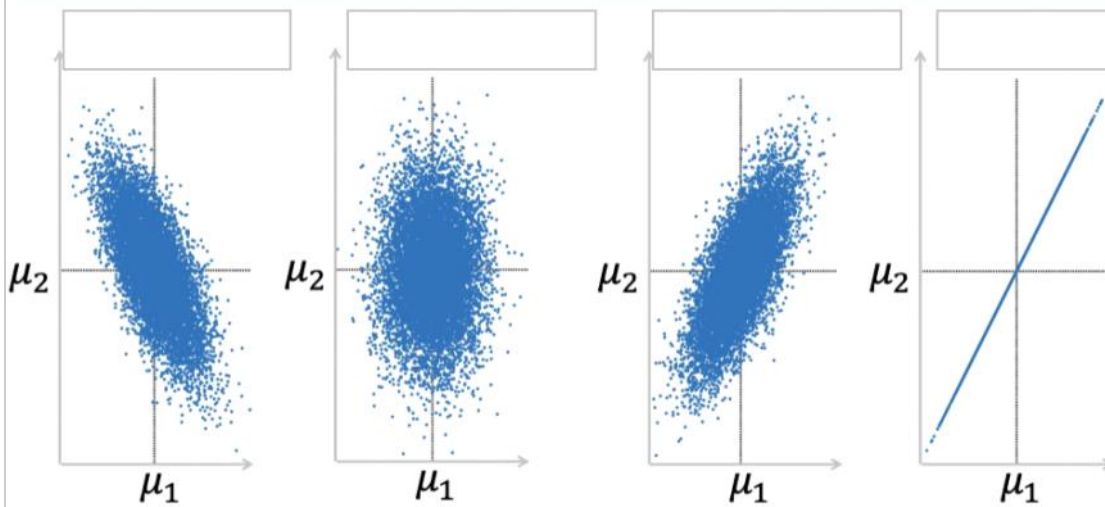
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Correlation

- Correlation coefficient

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Correlation



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Questions, comments,
or concerns?

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